Direct Report Portfolio Manager for Unmanned Systems (DRPM UxS)
2027 Small Business Innovation Research (SBIR) BAA
Release 1
Proposal Submission Instructions

INTRODUCTION

The Office of the Secretary of War (OSW) SBIR/STTR Program supports the rapid maturation of commercial and dual-use technology to meet operational needs across the Department. Under this release, the Direct Report Portfolio Manager for Unmanned Systems (DRPM UxS), in partnership with the Office of the Assistant Secretary of War for Special Operations and Low Intensity Conflict (OASW(SO/LIC)), is the sponsoring organization for the Counter-Unmanned Aerial Systems Rapid Maturation effort.

These instructions apply to the following topics in this release:

- **OSW27BZ01-NV001**, Counter-Unmanned Aerial Systems Rapid Maturation. This topic accepts Phase I proposals only.
- **OSW27BZ01-DV002**, Counter-Unmanned Aerial Systems Rapid Maturation. This topic accepts Direct to Phase II proposals only.

Proposers must select the topic corresponding to the type of proposal they intend to submit. The Phase I Proposal Guidelines below apply to OSW27BZ01-NV001. The Direct to Phase II Proposal Guidelines apply to OSW27BZ01-DV002.

Proposers responding to a topic in this solicitation must follow all general instructions provided in the Department of War (DoW) SBIR Program solicitation. DRPM UxS requirements in addition to or deviating from the DoW Program solicitation are provided in the instructions below. Where these instructions and the DoW SBIR Program BAA conflict, the DoW SBIR Program BAA governs.

Proposers are encouraged to thoroughly review the DoW solicitation and register for the DSIP Listserv to remain apprised of important programmatic and contractual changes.

- The full DoW solicitation is available on DSIP at https://www.dodsbirsttr.mil/submissions/solicitation-documents/active-solicitations. Be sure to select the tab for the appropriate solicitation cycle.
- Register for the DSIP Listserv at: https://www.dodsbirsttr.mil/submissions/login.

Specific questions pertaining to the administration of the **DRPM UxS** SBIR/STTR Program and these proposal preparation instructions shall be directed to: Lerani Wolk, lerani.v.wolk.civ@mail.mil.

PHASE I PROPOSAL GUIDELINES

The guidelines in this section apply to topic OSW27BZ01-NV001. The DoW SBIR/STTR Innovation Portal (DSIP) is the official portal for DoW SBIR/STTR proposal submission. Proposers are required to submit proposals via DSIP; proposals submitted by any other means will be disregarded. Detailed instructions regarding registration and proposal submission via DSIP are provided in the DoW solicitation.

Proposal Coversheet (Volume 1)

The proposal coversheet is prepared on DSIP and in accordance with the DoW solicitation. The technical abstract and the anticipated benefits and commercial applications discussion may be publicly released if the proposal is selected. Do not include proprietary, export-controlled, controlled unclassified, or classified information in any coversheet field intended for public release.

Technical Volume (Volume 2)
The technical volume is not to exceed two (2) pages and must follow the formatting requirements provided in the DoW SBIR solicitation, except that the Technical Volume must be uploaded as one searchable Portable Document Format (PDF), must use consecutively numbered pages, and must include the proposing small business concern's name, topic number, and DSIP-assigned proposal number in the header of each page. Graphics, tables, charts, references, and attachments included in Volume 2 count toward the page limit. Any pages in the technical volume over two pages will not be considered in proposal evaluations.

Content of the Technical Volume
The proposing small business concern must prepare Volume 2 **using the Phase I Technical Volume Template** provided as a separate attachment to this topic. The template identifies the content required in each section and corresponds to the criteria in the Phase I Evaluation Rubric. Volume 2 must state where the proposed approach stands against each of the four operating preferences identified in the topic.

Cost Volume (Volume 3)
The Phase I amount must not exceed $300,000. There is no priced option under this topic. The maximum Phase I period of performance is six (6) months.

Cost is not an evaluation criterion under this topic. The Government will review Volume 3 for completeness, allowability, reasonableness, compliance with the cost ceiling, and compliance with applicable percentage-of-work requirements.

Please review the updated Percentage of Work (POW) calculation details included in the DoW solicitation. **DRPM UxS** will not accept any deviation to the POW requirements.

Company Commercialization Report (CCR) (Volume 4)
Completion of the CCR as Volume 4 of the proposal submission in DSIP is required. Please refer to the DoW solicitation for full details on this requirement. Information contained in the CCR will not be considered by **DRPM UxS** during proposal evaluations.

Supporting Documents (Volume 5)
Volume 5 is provided for proposing Small Business Concerns (SBCs) to submit additional documentation to support the Coversheet (Volume 1), Technical Volume (Volume 2), and the Cost Volume (Volume 3). Please refer to the DoW solicitation for more information. Supporting documents must not be used to evade the Technical Volume page limit. Evaluators will consider only those documents identified as evaluable in these instructions and the applicable rubric.

Fraud, Waste and Abuse Training (Volume 6)
Fraud, Waste and Abuse training material can be found in the Volume 6 section of the proposal submission module in DSIP and must be thoroughly reviewed once per year to proceed with proposal submission.

Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries (Volume 7)
SBCs must complete the Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries webform in Volume 7 of the DSIP proposal submission. Please be aware that the Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries WILL NOT be accepted as a PDF Supporting Document in Volume 5 of the DSIP proposal submission. Do not upload any previous versions of this form to Volume 5. For additional details, please refer to the DoW Program BAA.

DIRECT TO PHASE II (D2P2) PROPOSAL GUIDELINES
The guidelines in this section apply to topic OSW27BZ01-DV002.

15 U.S.C. §638 (cc), allows DoW to make a SBIR Phase II award to a small business concern with respect to a project, without regard to whether the small business concern was provided an award under Phase I of the SBIR program with respect to such project.

This topic requires that proposers provide documentation to demonstrate that the feasibility described in the Phase I portion of the topic has been met. **Feasibility documentation cannot be based upon or logically extend from any prior or ongoing federally funded SBIR or STTR work.** Work submitted within the feasibility documentation must have been substantially performed by the proposer and/or the principal investigator (PI). If technology in the feasibility documentation is subject to intellectual property (IP), the proposer must either own the IP or must have obtained license rights to such technology prior to proposal submission, to enable it and its subcontractors to legally carry out the proposed work.

If the proposer fails to demonstrate technical merit and feasibility equivalent to the Phase I level as described in the associated topic, the related Phase II proposal will not be evaluated.

DRPM UxS deviation from the standard Direct to Phase II volume structure: under this topic, the Technical Volume is limited to five (5) pages in total and constitutes the entire body of the D2P2 technical proposal. Phase I-equivalent feasibility documentation is submitted separately, as evidence in Volume 5, limited to five (5) pages, rather than as part of Volume 2. This structure is intentional and reflects the short-form submission model used for this topic.

Complete D2P2 proposals must include the following:
- Volume 1: Proposal Cover Sheet
- Volume 2: Technical Volume (5 page Maximum, total)
- Volume 3: Cost Volume
- Volume 4: Company Commercialization Report
- Volume 5: Supporting Documents, including Phase I-equivalent feasibility documentation (5 page Maximum)
- Volume 6: Fraud Waste and Abuse Certification
- Volume 7: Disclosure of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries

Phase II proposals require a comprehensive, detailed submission of the proposed effort. Commercial and military potential of the technology under development is extremely important. Proposals emphasizing dual-use applications and commercial exploitation of resulting technologies are sought.

Volume 1 - Cover Sheet
The proposal cover sheet is prepared on DSIP. The cover sheet must include a brief technical abstract that describes the proposed R&D project and an anticipated benefits and potential commercial applications discussion. Each section shall be no more than 3,000 characters. **Do not include proprietary or classified information in the proposal cover sheet.** If your proposal is selected for negotiation and possible award, the technical abstract and anticipated benefits discussion may be publicly released online. DSIP will assign a proposal number once the cover sheet is saved. You may modify the cover sheet as needed until the topic closes.

Volume 2 - Technical Volume (5 pages)
The Direct to Phase II Technical Volume must not exceed five (5) pages in total, inclusive of all graphics, figures, tables, charts, citations, and attachments contained in Volume 2. This five-page limit covers the entire body of the proposal. Pages exceeding the established limit will not be evaluated. The formatting

requirements stated in the Phase I Technical Volume section above apply equally to Direct to Phase II proposals.

The proposing SBC must prepare Volume 2 **using the Direct to Phase II Technical Volume Template** provided as a separate attachment to this topic. The template identifies the content required in each section and corresponds to the criteria in the Direct to Phase II Evaluation Rubric. Volume 2 must state where the proposed approach stands against each of the four operating preferences identified in the topic.

Proposers are responsible for planning and budgeting for required test authority, range access, spectrum authorization, threat surrogates, equipment, facilities, and other resources necessary to execute the proposed effort.

Volume 3 - Cost Volume
Direct to Phase II proposals must not exceed a cost of $2,000,000 and a duration of twelve (12) months.

A detailed, Phase II Cost Volume must be submitted online and in the proper format shown in the Cost Breakdown Guidance in the DoW SBIR Program BAA. Some items in the cost volume template may not apply to the proposed project. Provide enough information to allow evaluators to assess the proposer's plans to use the requested funds if the contract is awarded.

Cost is not an evaluation criterion under this topic. The Government will review Volume 3 for completeness, allowability, reasonableness, compliance with the cost ceiling, and compliance with applicable percentage-of-work requirements. **DRPM UxS** will not accept any deviation to the POW requirements.

Volume 4 - Company Commercialization Report (CCR) (Required)
Completion of the CCR as Volume 4 of the proposal submission in DSIP is required. Please refer to the DoW SBIR Program BAA for full details on this requirement. The information contained in the CCR will not be considered during proposal evaluations.

Volume 5 - Supporting Documents
Volume 5 must include all documents and certifications required by the DoW SBIR Program BAA and these Component-Specific Proposal Submission Instructions.

Phase I-equivalent feasibility documentation is required in Volume 5 and must not exceed five (5) pages. Feasibility documentation is supporting evidence and does not count toward the five-page Technical Volume limit. The documentation must demonstrate that:

- The proposed technology has achieved the scientific and technical merit and feasibility described in the Phase I portion of this topic;
- The documented work was substantially performed by the proposing SBC and/or the proposed PI;
- The feasibility work was not based solely on, and does not logically extend from, prior or ongoing federally funded SBIR or STTR work;
- The proposing SBC owns, or holds sufficient license rights to, any intellectual property necessary for the concern and its subcontractors to perform the proposed effort; and
- The prior work supports the proposed technical approach, performance objectives, and transition or commercialization potential.

Acceptable feasibility evidence may include test data, analyses, technical reports, prototype descriptions, modeling and simulation results, laboratory or field-test results, relevant internal research and development results, and other objective evidence of feasibility. A system design alone is not sufficient. A self-declared technology readiness level unsupported by a documented test is not sufficient.

Volume 5 may also include data-rights assertions, subcontractor or consultant letters of commitment, documentation supporting proposed costs, prior/current/pending support information, and foreign-citizen information, each as applicable. Supporting documents must not be used to evade the Technical Volume page limit.

Volume 6 - Fraud Waste and Abuse Certification (Required)
Fraud, Waste and Abuse training material can be found in the Volume 6 section of the proposal submission module in DSIP and must be thoroughly reviewed once per year to proceed with proposal submission.

Volume 7 - Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries (Required)
Small business concerns must complete the Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries webform in Volume 7 of the DSIP proposal submission. Please be aware that the Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries WILL NOT be accepted as a PDF Supporting Document in Volume 5 of the DSIP proposal submission. Do not upload any previous versions of this form to Volume 5. For additional details, please refer to the DoW SBIR Program BAA.

PHASE II PROPOSAL GUIDELINES
Phase II proposals under OSW27BZ01-NV001 may only be submitted by Phase I awardees under that topic. A Phase I award does not guarantee a Phase II award. Subject to successful completion of Phase I, demonstrated technical progress, continued Government need, availability of funds, and all applicable statutory, regulatory, and DoW SBIR Program BAA requirements, a Phase I awardee may be eligible for a subsequent Phase II award without further competition.

The Government may request a Phase II proposal from an eligible Phase I awardee during the Phase I period of performance or after Phase I completion. Any such request will provide the applicable proposal due date, technical requirements, cost and period-of-performance limits, evaluation criteria, and submission instructions.

The anticipated Phase II objective is to mature the selected capability to a functional system, software package, or physical prototype suitable for test and evaluation in a militarily relevant or simulated field environment, with a target of Technology Readiness Level 6. The anticipated Phase II period of performance is twelve (12) months. Proposers shall not assume that a Phase I award, or a request for a Phase II proposal, constitutes a commitment of future funding.

DISCRETIONARY TECHNICAL AND BUSINESS ASSISTANCE (TABA)
The OSW SBIR/STTR Program will consider TABA requests in accordance with 15 U.S.C. § 638(q). Phase I awardees may request up to $6,500 in TABA funding; Phase II awardees may request up to $50,000 per Phase II project. TABA funding is in addition to the Phase I and Phase II cost ceilings and is not subject to profit/fee. Refer to the DoW Program BAA for detailed information about TABA funding, allowable services and requirements.

All requests for TABA must be completed using the SBIR/STTR TABA Request Form found here. The completed form must be included in Volume 5 of the proposal submission in DSIP. OSW will not accept requests for TABA that do not utilize the SBIR/STTR TABA Request Form or as a submission document included in Volume 5.

EVALUATION AND SELECTION
All proposals will be evaluated in accordance with the evaluation criteria listed in the DoW solicitation. In addition, proposals under these topics will be evaluated using the criteria and rating approach in the separate evaluation rubric applicable to the proposal type:

Phase I Evaluation Rubric for OSW27BZ01-NV001

Dimension	Subdimension	Unsatisfactory	Marginal	Satisfactory	Superior
INTRODUCTION weight 5%	—	Ineffective summary. Fails to convey what the system does or which kill-chain area it addresses.	Partial summary. Reader grasps the general domain but not the specific approach or kill-chain focus.	Effective summary. Clearly conveys the proposed system, its kill-chain focus, and its value to the c-UAS mission.	Exceptional summary. Immediately orients the reader to the system, kill-chain area, and differentiated value in a single compelling passage.
MISSION RELEVANCE weight 24%	**Kill-Chain Alignment**	Fails to articulate which kill-chain gap the system addresses or how it improves capability against Group 1/2 UAS.	Identifies a kill-chain area but the connection between the proposed capability and the operational gap is vague or generic.	Clearly maps the proposed capability to a specific kill-chain gap against Group 1/2 UAS. The operational improvement is tangible and credible.	Precisely maps the capability to a high-priority kill-chain gap. The operational improvement is compelling, specific, and grounded in realistic threat scenarios.
	Operating Preference Posture	One or more of the four operating preferences is unaddressed. The system's posture is unclear.	All four preferences addressed but the system meets few. Dependence on target emissions, own-force radiation, cloud services, or a dedicated operator is acknowledged but not mitigated.	All four preferences addressed clearly. The system meets most or provides credible mitigation for those it does not.	All four preferences addressed with specificity. The system meets all or nearly all with evidence or design rationale. Any exception is minor and convincingly mitigated.
	SOF Employability	No evidence the system can move with a tactical force. Size, weight, power, setup, or manning requirements are unaddressed.	System may be employable in tactical settings but key logistics questions (transport, setup time, power, manning) are only partially addressed.	System is clearly designed for tactical employment. Transport, setup, power, and manning are addressed and compatible with mobile force operations.	System is demonstrably optimized for tactical mobility. Fast setup, low power, minimal manning, and compatibility with standard military transport are evident or convincingly argued.
DEMAND SIGNAL weight 30%	**Operational Force Demand**	This solution does not belong in an operational kit. I see no reason to carry it.	This solution has potential but it has to improve in multiple dimensions to earn a place in my kit.	With a key improvement or two, this solution earns a place in my kit.	I would find a place in my kit for this solution.
TECHNICAL MERIT weight 24%	**Scientific Feasibility**	Core mechanism is stated but without scientific or engineering rationale. Evidence, if present, does not connect to the claimed approach.	Approach has a plausible scientific basis. Key assumptions are identified but untested or weakly supported. Gaps in the technical argument remain.	Approach is grounded in sound science or engineering with credible supporting evidence. Key assumptions are identified and defensible.	Approach is convincingly grounded in demonstrated science or engineering. Supporting evidence — test data, modeling, or peer-reviewed work — directly validates the core mechanism.
	Prototype Maturation Path	Current maturity is unclear or the gap to a fieldable prototype is unaddressed.	A path to a fieldable prototype is sketched. Timeline or key risks are acknowledged but not convincingly addressed.	Credible path from current maturity to a fieldable prototype. Key technical risks are identified with mitigation approaches.	Convincing path to a fieldable prototype. Current maturity is high, remaining risks are well-understood, and the plan accounts for test in a relevant environment.
COMMERCIAL VIABILITY weight 12%	**Firm Survival Risk**	Fails to demonstrate solvency through the next two years.	Marginally demonstrates solvency through the next two years.	Credibly demonstrates solvency through the next two years.	Convincingly demonstrates solvency through the next two years.
SUBMISSION QUALITY weight 5%	**Quality of Prose**	Prose is unclear, disorganized, or contains significant errors that impede understanding.	Prose is understandable but uneven. Some sections are unclear or poorly organized.	Prose is clear, well-organized, and professional throughout. Technical claims are supported.	Prose is exceptionally clear and concise. Every sentence advances the argument. Technical claims are well-supported with data or evidence.

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Direct to Phase II Evaluation Rubric for OSW27BZ01-DV002

Dimension	Subdimension	Unsatisfactory	Marginal	Satisfactory	Superior
INTRODUCTION weight 5%	—	Ineffective summary. Fails to convey what the system does or which kill-chain area it addresses.	Partial summary. Reader grasps the general domain but not the specific approach or kill-chain focus.	Effective summary. Clearly conveys the proposed system, its kill-chain focus, and its value to the c-UAS mission.	Exceptional summary. Immediately orients the reader to the system, kill-chain area, and differentiated value in a single compelling passage.
MISSION RELEVANCE weight 24%	**Kill-Chain Alignment**	Fails to articulate which kill-chain gap the system addresses or how it improves capability against Group 1/2 UAS.	Identifies a kill-chain area but the connection between the proposed capability and the operational gap is vague or generic.	Clearly maps the proposed capability to a specific kill-chain gap against Group 1/2 UAS. The operational improvement is tangible and credible.	Precisely maps the capability to a high-priority kill-chain gap. The operational improvement is compelling, specific, and grounded in realistic threat scenarios.
	Operating Preference Posture	One or more of the four operating preferences is unaddressed. The system's posture is unclear.	All four preferences addressed but the system meets few. Dependence on target emissions, own-force radiation, cloud services, or a dedicated operator is acknowledged but not mitigated.	All four preferences addressed clearly. The system meets most or provides credible mitigation for those it does not.	All four preferences addressed with specificity. The system meets all or nearly all with evidence or design rationale. Any exception is minor and convincingly mitigated.
	SOF Employability	No evidence the system can move with a tactical force. Size, weight, power, setup, or manning requirements are unaddressed.	System may be employable in tactical settings but key logistics questions (transport, setup time, power, manning) are only partially addressed.	System is clearly designed for tactical employment. Transport, setup, power, and manning are addressed and compatible with mobile force operations.	System is demonstrably optimized for tactical mobility. Fast setup, low power, minimal manning, and compatibility with standard military transport are evident or convincingly argued.
DEMAND SIGNAL weight 30%	**Operational Force Demand**	This solution does not belong in an operational kit. I see no reason to carry it.	This solution has potential but it has to improve in multiple dimensions to earn a place in my kit.	With a key improvement or two, this solution earns a place in my kit.	I would find a place in my kit for this solution.
VALIDATED TECHNICAL MATURITY weight 12%	**Documented Test Evidence**	Self-declares a TRL with no documented test results or only references design-level artifacts such as block diagrams or simulation outputs.	Provides test documentation but key details are missing: conditions, dates, threat surrogates, or measured results are incomplete or ambiguous.	Provides documented test results stating conditions, dates, threat surrogates used, and measured results. Evidence is credibly attributed and supports the claimed maturity level.	Provides multiple documented test events with clearly stated conditions, dates, surrogates, and measured results. Evidence is independently verifiable or third-party validated.
	Current Technical Readiness	Evidence supports TRL 3 or below. Feasibility has not been demonstrated beyond analytical or laboratory proof-of-concept.	Evidence supports TRL 4. Critical function demonstrated in a laboratory or controlled environment but not in a relevant setting.	Evidence supports TRL 5. Critical function validated in a relevant environment with representative conditions.	Evidence supports TRL 6 or higher. System or subsystem demonstrated in a relevant environment with realistic inputs and operating conditions.
TRADE STUDY EXAMPLE weight 6%	**Engineering Trade-Offs**	No trade studies presented, or the response asserts that the design required no meaningful trades. The engineering rationale behind key design choices is absent.	Identifies a trade study but presents it superficially — alternatives considered are obvious, evaluation criteria are vague, and the rationale for the selected approach lacks quantitative support.	Describes a substantive trade study with clearly defined alternatives, evaluation criteria, and a reasoned selection supported by data or analysis. The trade reveals genuine engineering judgment.	Presents a rigorous trade study that quantitatively compares alternatives against mission-relevant criteria, documents what was sacrificed and why, and reveals sophisticated understanding of the design space and its boundaries.
PROTOTYPE DELIVERY PLAN weight 12%	**Prototype Definition**	The end-state prototype is undefined or described only in abstract terms. It is unclear what the Government would receive at the end of the POP.	The prototype is described at a high level but key attributes — form factor, performance targets, test-readiness — are vague or aspirational.	The prototype is concretely defined: what it is, what it does, its target performance envelope, and its readiness for test and evaluation in a relevant environment.	The prototype is precisely defined with specific performance targets, physical characteristics, and a clear description of the test and evaluation scenario it is designed to support. The deliverable is unambiguous.
	Milestone Credibility	Milestones are missing, vague, or not scoped to a 12-month period of performance. No clear connection between proposed work and a deliverable prototype.	Milestones are present and nominally scoped to 12 months, but sequencing is questionable, dependencies are unaddressed, or the schedule appears padded or compressed without justification.	Milestones are clearly defined, logically sequenced, and scoped to a 12-month POP. Dependencies are identified. The path from current state to deliverable prototype is credible.	Milestones are specific, sequenced with explicit dependencies, and include measurable exit criteria at each stage. The 12-month schedule is tightly justified with margin identified and allocated.
	Technical Risks and Mitigations	Technical risks are unacknowledged or dismissed. No mitigation plans are presented.	Some risks are identified but mitigations are vague, overly optimistic, or do not address the highest-consequence risks on the path to prototype.	Key technical risks on the path to prototype are identified with specific, credible mitigation plans. The team demonstrates awareness of what could go wrong and has planned for it.	Risks are enumerated with clear severity and likelihood reasoning. Mitigations are specific, resourced, and include fallback approaches. The risk posture reflects an engineering team that has confronted these problems before.

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Direct to Phase II proposals will first undergo a feasibility determination using the Volume 5 feasibility documentation. Only proposals that establish Phase I-equivalent feasibility will proceed to evaluation of the technical proposal. If the Government determines that the proposer has not established feasibility, the proposal will not receive further evaluation. The Government will evaluate only the material permitted by these instructions and the applicable rubric.

All awards are subject to the availability of funds. The Government reserves the right to make one or more awards, or no award, under either topic, and to limit the number of awards based on availability of funds. The Government is not obligated to make an award. Submission of a proposal does not authorize the proposer to begin work or incur costs on behalf of the Government.

DRPMUxS uses support contractor personnel in the administration of these topics. Support contractor personnel with access to proposal information are subject to non-disclosure obligations and may not participate in source selection decisions.

Proposing firms will be notified of selection or non-selection status within 90 days of the closing date of the topic. Notification will be provided through DSIP to the Corporate Official identified in the proposal, with a copy to the Principal Investigator.

Refer to the DoW solicitation for procedures to protest the Announcement.

AWARD INFORMATION
Direct Report Portfolio Manager for Unmanned Systems (DRPM UxS) intends to execute prototype other transaction agreement awards as a result of this solicitation in accordance with 10 U.S.C. 4022.

The projected Cybersecurity Maturity Model Certification (CMMC) level at the time of award for these topics is Level 2 (Self). A firm without a current self-assessment posted in Supplier Performance Risk System (SPRS) is strongly encouraged to begin that process now. This must be completed by time of award.

These topics are International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR) restricted. The restriction paragraph published with each topic applies, including disclosure of any proposed use of foreign nationals.

SBIR data rights attach to technical data and computer software developed under an award. Proposers shall mark proprietary material in accordance with the DoW SBIR Program BAA and shall assert any restricted or limited rights in the proposal rather than after award.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION
Proposers are responsible for obtaining and accounting for the test authorities, range access, spectrum authorization, threat surrogates, equipment, facilities, and other resources necessary to execute the proposed effort. These requirements must be reflected in the proposed schedule and cost.

Authority to mitigate or defeat unmanned aircraft in the United States is limited by statute to covered Federal entities. Proposers shall not assume that an award under either topic provides authority to mitigate or defeat unmanned aircraft, or guarantees access to Government ranges, spectrum, threat surrogates, test resources, or facilities. Where practicable, the Government may assist awardees in arranging range access, threat surrogates, or spectrum authorization. No such Government support is committed or guaranteed by this announcement.

The Government may host a capability showcase approximately six months after award. Attendance is by invitation and is based on end-user interest in the capability. It is not required of every performer. Performers shall provide operational evidence supporting a follow-on funding decision whether or not they are invited.

DRPMUxS SBIR DOW 2027 BAA
Topic Index
Release 1

OSW27BZ01-NV001 Counter-Unmanned Aerial Systems Rapid Maturation

OSW27BZ01-DV002 Counter-Unmanned Aerial Systems Rapid Maturation

OSW27BZ01-NV001 TITLE: Counter-Unmanned Aerial Systems Rapid Maturation

OUSW (R&E) CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY AREA(S): Applied Artificial Intelligence

COMPONENT TECHNOLOGY PRIORITY AREA(S): Trusted AI and Autonomy; Integrated Sensing and Cyber; Integrated Network Systems-of-Systems; Advanced Infrastructure & Advanced Manufacturing

PROJECTED CMMC LEVEL REQUIREMENT: Level 2 (Self)

The technology within this topic is restricted under the International Traffic in Arms Regulation (ITAR), 22 CFR Parts 120-130, which controls the export and import of defense-related material and services, including export of sensitive technical data, or the Export Administration Regulation (EAR), 15 CFR Parts 730-774, which controls dual use items. Offerors must disclose any proposed use of foreign nationals (FNs), their country(ies) of origin, the type of visa or work permit possessed, and the statement of work (SOW) tasks intended for accomplishment by the FN(s) in accordance with the Announcement. Offerors are advised foreign nationals proposed to perform on this topic may be restricted due to the technical data under US Export Control Laws.

OBJECTIVE: Mature commercial and dual-use technologies that detect, track, identify, or defeat small low-flying drones (Group 1 and Group 2 unmanned aerial systems) in hostile or contested areas.

DESCRIPTION: Inexpensive, highly maneuverable, commercially available unmanned aerial systems (UAS) threaten tactical forces, critical infrastructure, and installations. Current defenses are limited by cost, by the operator attention they require, and by their vulnerability to countermeasures. A capability gap against Group 1 and Group 2 UAS remains.

This topic seeks mature or maturing technology at any point in the counter-UAS kill chain. The three areas below are where capability is most needed. They are examples. A proposal may address one area, more than one, or a gap not listed here.

Detection and Tracking. Detect and hold track on highly agile targets in cluttered low-altitude airspace. The proposer selects the sensing modality. Approaches that hold track when the target is not emitting are preferred. Solutions that require permanent site infrastructure or mains power, including fixed perimeter sensor installations, are out of scope for this area. The system must move with the force.

Identification and Decision Support. Classify and identify unauthorized platforms and support an engagement decision. Processing must run on tactical computing hardware carried or emplaced with the force. Proposals should describe a pathway to interoperate with existing command and control. Conformance to a named standard is not required at this stage and will not be scored.

Mitigation and Defeat. Kinetic, non-kinetic, or cyber approaches that defeat hostile UAS in remote tactical theaters and in densely populated areas. Proposals must address collateral effects.
Operating preferences. The operating environment is denied, contested, and unattended. The four conditions below are preferences, not eligibility requirements.

Every proposal must state where it stands against each one.
(a) The system does not require the target to emit radio frequency (RF) energy. Passive RF may be part of a solution; the preference is that track holds when the target is silent.
(b) The system does not radiate. The Government favors kinetic and cyber defeat over approaches that require the friendly system to emit. Jamming, active illumination, and transmission into a target's control

or navigation link are in scope. A proposal that uses any of them must say so and describe the operational effect.
(c) The system does not require cloud services or reachback. Training and analytics may occur off-platform. The processing that produces the operational output should run on the platform, and the system should continue to function with all external network interfaces disabled.
(d) The system does not require a dedicated operator, meaning no person whose only task is attending it. Human judgment over the use of force is expected and is not addressed by this preference.

Out of scope: work requiring classified access or a facility clearance at the time of award, and approaches that depend on cooperative identification, including Remote ID broadcast.

PHASE I: Phase I shall determine the technical, scientific, and commercial feasibility of the proposed approach. Work may include developing a concept architecture, modeling critical software components, or bench testing key hardware elements. Phase I deliverables are a feasibility study, a technical report, and an initial system design package showing the path to a prototype.

The technical report shall state the conditions, dates, and target or threat surrogate used in any testing performed, and the measured result. It shall also state where the approach stands against each of the four operating preferences.

As required by the DoW solicitation, the feasibility documented may not rest solely upon, or logically extend from, prior or ongoing federally funded SBIR or STTR work; the proposing firm and/or the principal investigator must have substantially performed the work relied upon; and the firm must demonstrate ownership or licensure of the associated intellectual property prior to proposal submission.

PHASE II: Phase II follow-on depends on the availability of future-year funds and will be considered among the Phase I awardees under this topic.

Phase II is a major research and development effort. Performers refine the Phase I concept into an operational prototype that demonstrates real-world functionality. The primary deliverable is a functional system, software package, or physical prototype ready for test and evaluation in a militarily relevant or simulated field environment. The technology shall reach TRL 6 by the end of Phase II.

The period of performance is twelve months rather than the twenty-four the announcement allows. The intent is to move a demonstrated capability to a transition decision within one year. Proposals should be scoped to that schedule.

The Government may host a showcase about six months after award. Attendance is by invitation and is based on end user interest in the capability. It is not required of every performer. Performers shall provide operational evidence supporting a follow-on funding decision whether or not they are invited.

PHASE III DUAL USE APPLICATIONS: Commercial applications are those in which the equipment deploys with a team rather than being installed at a site: temporary airspace security for outdoor events, venues, and construction or energy sites; convoy, executive, and site-survey protection; wildfire, disaster, and critical infrastructure response; and mobile detection kits for law enforcement and allied partners. Detection, tracking, and identification technologies have a direct commercial market in these roles. Authority to mitigate or defeat unmanned aircraft in the United States is limited by statute to covered federal entities. A defeat-focused proposal is not expected to show a near-term domestic commercial market for that function.

Military applications include integration into point-defense systems for tactical units, forward operating bases, and naval vessel protection platforms, which may be funded via non-SBIR/STTR acquisition budgets.

REFERENCES:

1. Congressional Research Service. Department of Defense Counter Unmanned Aircraft Systems: Background and Issues for Congress. Report R48477. https://www.congress.gov/crs-product/R48477
2. Statement of General Michael E. Kurilla, Commander, U.S. Central Command, before the Senate Armed Services Committee on the posture of U.S. Central Command, 10 June 2025.
3. U.S. Department of Defense Counter-Small Unmanned Aircraft Systems Strategy (2021). https://media.defense.gov/2021/Jan/07/2002561080/-1/-1/1/DEPARTMENT-OF-DEFENSE-COUNTER-SMALL-UNMANNED-AIRCRAFT-SYSTEMS-STRATEGY.PDF

KEYWORDS: Counter-UAS; C-sUAS; Group 1 UAS; Group 2 UAS; autonomous threat detection; edge artificial intelligence; multi-sensor fusion; denied environment

OSW27BZ01-DV002 TITLE: Counter-Unmanned Aerial Systems Rapid Maturation

OUSW (R&E) CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY AREA(S): Applied Artificial Intelligence

COMPONENT TECHNOLOGY PRIORITY AREA(S): Trusted AI and Autonomy; Integrated Sensing and Cyber; Integrated Network Systems-of-Systems; Advanced Infrastructure & Advanced Manufacturing

PROJECTED CMMC LEVEL REQUIREMENT: Level 2 (Self)

The technology within this topic is restricted under the International Traffic in Arms Regulation (ITAR), 22 CFR Parts 120-130, which controls the export and import of defense-related material and services, including export of sensitive technical data, or the Export Administration Regulation (EAR), 15 CFR Parts 730-774, which controls dual use items. Offerors must disclose any proposed use of foreign nationals (FNs), their country(ies) of origin, the type of visa or work permit possessed, and the statement of work (SOW) tasks intended for accomplishment by the FN(s) in accordance with the Announcement. Offerors are advised foreign nationals proposed to perform on this topic may be restricted due to the technical data under US Export Control Laws.

OBJECTIVE: Mature commercial and dual-use technologies that detect, track, identify, or defeat small low-flying drones (Group 1 and Group 2 unmanned aerial systems) in hostile or contested areas.

DESCRIPTION: Inexpensive, highly maneuverable, commercially available unmanned aerial systems (UAS) threaten tactical forces, critical infrastructure, and installations. Current defenses are limited by cost, by the operator attention they require, and by their vulnerability to countermeasures. A capability gap against Group 1 and Group 2 UAS remains.

This topic seeks mature or maturing technology at any point in the counter-UAS kill chain. The three areas below are where capability is most needed. They are examples. A proposal may address one area, more than one, or a gap not listed here.

Detection and Tracking. Detect and hold track on highly agile targets in cluttered low-altitude airspace. The proposer selects the sensing modality. Approaches that hold track when the target is not emitting are preferred. Solutions that require permanent site infrastructure or mains power, including fixed perimeter sensor installations, are out of scope for this area. The system must move with the force.
Identification and Decision Support. Classify and identify unauthorized platforms and support an engagement decision. Processing must run on tactical computing hardware carried or emplaced with the force. Proposals should describe a pathway to interoperate with existing command and control. Conformance to a named standard is not required at this stage and will not be scored.

Mitigation and Defeat. Kinetic, non-kinetic, or cyber approaches that defeat hostile UAS in remote tactical theaters and in densely populated areas. Proposals must address collateral effects.
Operating preferences. The operating environment is denied, contested, and unattended. The four conditions below are preferences, not eligibility requirements.

Every proposal must state where it stands against each one.
(a) The system does not require the target to emit radio frequency (RF) energy. Passive RF may be part of a solution; the preference is that track holds when the target is silent.
(b) The system does not radiate. The Government favors kinetic and cyber defeat over approaches that require the friendly system to emit. Jamming, active illumination, and transmission into a target's control

or navigation link are in scope. A proposal that uses any of them must say so and describe the operational effect.
(c) The system does not require cloud services or reachback. Training and analytics may occur off-platform. The processing that produces the operational output should run on the platform, and the system should continue to function with all external network interfaces disabled.
(d) The system does not require a dedicated operator, meaning no person whose only task is attending it. Human judgment over the use of force is expected and is not addressed by this preference.
Out of scope: work requiring classified access or a facility clearance at the time of award, and approaches that depend on cooperative identification, including Remote ID broadcast.

PHASE I: This topic solicits Direct-to-Phase-II (DP2) proposals only. Direct to Phase II proposers shall submit documentation showing that Phase I-equivalent feasibility has already been achieved outside the SBIR/STTR program. Adequate documentation is a written record of at least one test of the proposed approach stating the conditions under which the test was conducted, the dates, the target, threat, or surrogate used, the measured result, and how it was measured.Test data, technical reports, and third-party evaluation metrics are acceptable. A system design alone is not sufficient. A self-declared technology readiness level unsupported by a documented test is not sufficient.

As required by the DoW solicitation, the feasibility documented may not rest solely upon, or logically extend from, prior or ongoing federally funded SBIR or STTR work; the proposing firm and/or the principal investigator must have substantially performed the work relied upon; and the firm must demonstrate ownership or licensure of the associated intellectual property prior to proposal submission.

PHASE II: Phase II is a major research and development effort. Performers refine the Phase I concept into an operational prototype that demonstrates real-world functionality. The primary deliverable is a functional system, software package, or physical prototype ready for test and evaluation in a militarily relevant or simulated field environment. The technology shall reach TRL 6 by the end of Phase II.
The period of performance is twelve months rather than the twenty-four the announcement allows. The intent is to move a demonstrated capability to a transition decision within one year. Proposals should be scoped to that schedule.

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